

HAPPY FACTORY

Game Draft • Satirical Time-Management Puzzle / Narrative Subversion

High Concept: A bright, addictive assembly-line game slowly reveals that the player's efficient factory work is contributing to Nazi Germany's war machine and the Final Solution. The horror comes from the changing meaning of familiar, rewarding mechanics.

CORE EXPERIENCE

Player fantasy: Be the fastest, most efficient worker on the line. Complete tickets, hit quotas, earn stars, and satisfy an increasingly demanding manager.

Narrative strategy: Do not explain the truth upfront. Let specifications, overheard phone calls, environmental details, lighting, and sound progressively recontextualize the player's actions.

"Congratulations! You're doing an excellent job." — a compliment that becomes horrifying by the end.

Level	Presentation	Gameplay / Narrative Signal
1 — Morning	Bright yellows + cyan; cheerful arcade music.	Simple containers and seals. Gold stars and combo feedback establish the productivity-game fantasy.
2 — Afternoon	Warm oranges + purples; longer shadows.	Specifications mention "airtight transit" requirements. Phone dialogue introduces unusual transport demands.
3 — Dusk	Deep purple + crimson; metallic sparks.	References to "rail car density" and "high volume" become increasingly difficult to ignore.
4 — Twilight	Navy blue + neon red alerts; claustrophobic lighting.	Ordering reference "special facilities in the East." The manager remains relentlessly upbeat.
5 — Midnight	Pitch black; single spotlight. Arcade music stops.	The General arrives in person. Final inspection, medal ceremony, and a wide reveal expose the industrial horror.

CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

Receive ticket → **assemble part** → **operate controls** → **test/seal** → **beat timer** → **receive feedback** → **repeat**. Players drag base components, attach abstract components such as filters, valves and heavy latches, then operate levers or valves to complete the specification. Speed and accuracy determine stars and bonuses.

Overheard dialogue: Periodic calls between the Manager and the General interrupt the workflow. The player can keep working while snippets of conversation provide context. The dialogue should feel incidental, not like an exposition dump.

CHARACTERS

Player Worker	Wide-eyed, soft chibi worker in an oversized jumpsuit. Wants only to meet the quota and do well.
Manager	Perky corporate bureaucrat with oversized round glasses. Clipboard, gold stars, bonuses and relentless positivity.
The General	Off-screen through Levels 1–4 via phone dialogue. Appears physically in Level 5 as a rigid WWII German high-command officer.

VISUAL & AUDIO DIRECTION

Art: Chibi pop-art with punk street-art energy—bold black linework, vibrant color blocking, expressive comic proportions, spray-painted/stenciled accents. The HAPPY FACTORY logo is a dripping punk stencil over a bright smiling pop-art face.

Audio: Start with cheerful arcade effects and upbeat music. Gradually introduce machinery, distant engines, metallic impacts and increasingly oppressive ambience. At Level 5, cut the arcade BGM completely; leave low engine rumble and heavy tank treads outside.

CLIMAX & FINAL IMAGE

At midnight, the General inspects the final part and approves it. The player receives a **Worker of the Month** medal. The game briefly treats this as a triumphant reward. Then the camera pulls back: the cute worker stands in front of a sprawling industrial map of occupied Europe. The cheerful productivity fantasy collapses into a visual statement about participation, bureaucracy and the human consequences hidden behind abstract work.

Design principle: The mechanics should remain deceptively simple; the player's understanding of what those mechanics mean should be what changes.